



Jamaica Constabulary Force
National Police College of Jamaica
Department of Weapons and Tactical Training Policy and Standard Operating Procedures

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1.0. INTRODUCTION

- 1.1. The Department of Weapons and Tactical Training (DWTT) is an integral unit of the National Police College of Jamaica (NPCJ). This Department has been established to facilitate the structured and standardized delivery of firearms, less-lethal weapons, and tactical training to members of the Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF), other law enforcement personnel, and approved government agencies. It supports the professional development of officers through programmes that emphasize human rights, risk management, ethical conduct, and operational proficiency.
- 1.2. This document outlines the operational policy and procedures guiding the DWTT's activities. It provides clear directives on the Department's mission, structure, training mandates, and functional responsibilities to ensure the highest standards of competence, safety, and accountability in weapons and tactical instruction across the JCF and authorized entities.

2.0. PURPOSE OF POLICY

- 2.1. The purpose of this Policy is to establish the DWTT, as a training entity of the National Police College of Jamaica (NPCJ) that will support the human resource development of the Jamaica Constabulary Force.

3.0. POLICY STATEMENTS

- 3.1. It is the policy of the DWTT to:
 - 3.1.1. Be a training entity that delivers training to, and certifies all JCF members in conflict de-escalation, the use of restraints, firearms, and less lethal weapons. The delivery of training shall be integrated across all NPCJ faculty programmes.
 - 3.1.2. Incorporate the teaching and emphasis of human rights as prerequisite to completing all training programmes.
 - 3.1.3. Provide training and certification for other government bodies and agencies authorized by the Minister or his designate
 - 3.1.4. Have Department Staff excluded from operational activities not forming a part of NPCJ training programmes.
 - 3.1.5. Have the structure of the Department include the establishment of a Head of Department filled at the rank of a Superintendent of Police.

4.0. ABBREVIATIONS

- 4.1. CDCD: Curriculum Development and Coordination Department
- 4.2. DWTT: Department of Weapons and Tactical Training
- 4.3. JCF: Jamaica Constabulary Force
- 4.4. NPCJ: National Police College of Jamaica
- 4.5. FATS: Firearms Training System
- 4.6. FIBUA: Fighting in Built-Up Areas
- 4.7. OC: Oleoresin Capsicum (Pepper Spray)

5.0. DEFINITIONS

5.1. Weapons Training

Instructional activities related to the handling, operation, care, and tactical use of firearms and less-lethal devices.

5.2. Tactical Training

Training that prepares personnel to handle dynamic, high-risk operational situations with minimal force and maximum safety.

5.3. Less-Lethal Weapons

Weapons intended to incapacitate a person while minimizing fatalities or permanent injury, including batons, pepper spray, and conducted energy devices.

5.4. Certification

A formal process by which a member is officially recognized as having met the requisite standard of proficiency in weapons or tactical training.

5.5. Operational Support Units (OSUs)

JCF units deployed to provide tactical and specialized support to general policing duties.

5.6. Instructor Certification

Recognition of a member's competence to train others in firearms or tactical areas as per established criteria.

6.0. STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES

6.1. Mission of the Department

6.2. The mission of the DWTT is to transform sworn members of the JCF, other law enforcement officials, and personnel from approved agencies into highly skilled operatives in their respective fields, equipped with the ethical mindset and tactical knowledge to safeguard lives, rights, property, and dignity in accordance with the Charter of Fundamental Rights 2011, while equipping them to train and mentor others in their respective fields through:

- 6.2.1. Delivering proven, high-quality, and legally defensible training in marksmanship, gun handling, tactics, mindset, and the legal use of lethal, and less lethal force to the sworn members at entry level;
- 6.2.2. Retraining and re-qualifying all sworn members of the JCF, Other law enforcement officials, and personnel from approved agencies in use, care and safe handling of lethal and less lethal service weapons;
- 6.2.3. Developing strategies and tactical training to minimize the use of lethal force;
- 6.2.4. Developing skills required for the safe and proficient use of firearms;
- 6.2.5. Inspiring a culture of active assessment of risk; and
- 6.2.6. Training of other government entities.

7.0. Vision of the Department

7.1. To be the premier weapons and tactical training department, delivering high-quality, innovative programs tailored to the evolving law enforcement and security needs of Jamaica and the Region. By integrating advanced tactical knowledge, ethical principles,

and instructor development, we strive to set the standard for excellence in preparing professionals to address modern challenges with skill, integrity, and resilience.

8.0. Objectives of the Department

8.1. The overall objectives of the Department are to:

- 8.1.1. Coordinate defensive training, including lethal and less lethal weapons for all members of the JCF;
- 8.1.2. Deliver beginner, refresher and advanced firearm training to all members of the JCF;
- 8.1.3. Deliver beginner and refresher training in less lethal weapons to all members of the JCF;
- 8.1.4. Deliver basic tactical training designed to prepare entry-level police recruits for general policing duties;
- 8.1.5. Deliver tactical courses to operational support teams, special weapons and tactical teams, and close protection officers;
- 8.1.6. Enhance the JCF's operational efficiency by designing courses, in conjunction with the NPCJ Curriculum Development Unit, customized to the security needs of the JCF;
- 8.1.7. Maintain an updated database of certified firearm, and less lethal device users within the JCF;
- 8.1.8. Train and maintain database of certified weapons training instructors; and
- 8.1.9. Deliver firearm, tactical, and less lethal weapons training to personnel of other government entities;
- 8.1.10. Deliver firearm, tactical, less-lethal weapons, and instructional delivery training to personnel of other government organizations; and
- 8.1.11. Deliver motor vehicle tactical training to approved entities.

9.0. Responsibilities

9.1. The duties and responsibilities to be undertaken by the Department are as follows:

- 9.1.1. Train all members of the JCF in the following areas:
 - 9.1.1.1. Human Rights principles and their application in policing.
 - 9.1.1.2. Police Use of Force and Firearms Policy, ensuring alignment with ethical and legal standards.
 - 9.1.1.3. Conflict Resolution and De-Escalation
 - 9.1.1.4. Firearm care, safe handling, and maintenance of all JCF-issued weapons
 - 9.1.1.5. Proper use and deployment of less-lethal and impact weapons
 - 9.1.1.6. Safe and effective application of restraints during operations
 - 9.1.1.7. Certify JCF members in the safe use, handling, and care of all JCF-issued weapons
 - 9.1.1.8. Conduct tactical training for members of the JCF and other law enforcement and government agencies
- 9.1.2. Manage the NPCJ armoury to ensure proper storage, accountability, and maintenance of weapons and ammunition.

- 9.1.3. Operate and manage the NPCJ shooting range, providing a safe and efficient facility for weapons training and certification.
- 9.1.4. Support the administrative review of firearm discharge incidents by providing expert analysis and recommendations.
- 9.1.5. Facilitate the selection, training, and continuous professional development of the Department's staff to uphold high operational and instructional standards.
- 9.1.6. Assist in developing and revising weapons policies and tactical protocols to meet the evolving needs of the JCF, while reviewing operational procedures to recommend improvements that enhance effectiveness and safety
- 9.1.7. Offer expert guidance on the sourcing, procurement, and deployment of munitions, equipment, and accoutrements for the JCF.
- 9.1.8. Provide technical support in the planning and execution of major JCF operations, ensuring tactical and operational readiness.
- 9.1.9. Deliver weapons and tactical training and certification for approved Government of Jamaica entities, ensuring interagency collaboration and standardization.
- 9.1.10. Train, certify, and recertify weapons and tactical instructors to maintain a cadre of highly skilled and qualified trainers.
- 9.1.11. Ensure all DWTT staff remain dedicated exclusively to training-related duties and responsibilities at the NPCJ, excluding them from external operational deployments.

10.0. Organization and Authority

10.1. Position in the NPCJ Structure

- 10.1.1. The DWTT shall be an independent department, and shall report directly to the Director, NPCJ.

10.2. Internal Organization and Structure

- 10.2.1. To successfully carry out the duties and responsibilities outlined above, the organizational structure attached to these Orders as Appendix 'A' shall be established and utilized.

10.3. Head of Department

- 10.3.1. The Commanding Officer will be filled by an officer at the rank of Superintendent of Police within the JCF.
- 10.3.2. The role and functions of the Head of Department are as follows:
 - 10.3.2.1. To have overall accountability for the accomplishment of the mandate of the Department;
 - 10.3.2.2. To report as a member of the Director's College Management Board;
 - 10.3.2.3. To direct all aspects of the JCF use of force and weapons programmes, including firearms and less lethal weapons;
 - 10.3.2.4. To direct the development and implementation of JCF use of force and weapons programmes, in collaboration with the JCF Planning, Research and Development Branch (PRDB);
 - 10.3.2.5. To forecast, and coordinate training schedule for the Department;

- 10.3.2.6. To direct the development of the training curriculum, and the training of NPCJ firearm instructors, armourers, defensive tactics instructors, and other related training, in collaboration with the NPCJ Curriculum Development Department (CDCD);
- 10.3.2.7. To direct the technical and evaluation aspects of the JCF use of force and weapons programmes;
- 10.3.2.8. To direct the collection and storage of qualification and instructor certification records;
- 10.3.2.9. To oversee the NPCJ armoury and direct the maintenance, repair, and alteration of all JCF issued and authorized weapons in the NPCJ custody and, or control;
- 10.3.2.10. To oversee the control and accountability of all NPCJ issued firearms, ammunition, and less lethal weapons and equipment;
- 10.3.2.11. To co-ordinate the Department's participation in administrative review of firearm discharges, and use of force complaints;
- 10.3.2.12. To establish criteria for selection and certification of weapons training instructors, in collaboration with JCF Human Resource Branch;
- 10.3.2.13. Oversee monthly physical inspections of firearms issued for keep and care to NPCJ staff; and
- 10.3.2.14. All other duties so directed by the Director, NPCJ.

10.4. Director, Training (Officer Second In-charge)

- 10.4.1. The Director, Training will be filled by an officer at the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police within the JCF. The role and function of the Director, Training are as follows:
 - 10.4.1.1. To act as the Head of Department in his/her absence and assume all attached responsibilities;
 - 10.4.1.2. To manage the daily operational, administrative and general human resource functions of the Department;
 - 10.4.1.3. To assign and co-ordinate all staff assignments;
 - 10.4.1.4. To co-ordinate the scheduling of firearm instructors, range commanders and safety officers to assist with firearms training, qualification, and certification;
 - 10.4.1.5. To co-ordinate the scheduling of officers participation in weapons qualification, and all applicable training including human rights, use of force, tactical exercises and other required training;
 - 10.4.1.6. To oversee verification and input of training qualification data in training database;
 - 10.4.1.7. To oversee certification of firearm user booklets;
 - 10.4.1.8. To initiate keep and care weapon retrieval process from officers failing to qualify;
 - 10.4.1.9. To coordinate training for weapons and tactical instructors; and
 - 10.4.1.10. To evaluate department staff performance and treat with welfare issues.

10.5. Tactical Training Unit

10.5.1. The Tactical Training Unit will be headed by a Manager at the rank of Inspector within the JCF. The Tactical Training Unit will develop the tactical acuity of members through delivery of a rigorous training programme to invest members with the flexibility and range to resolve street encounters with maximum safety. The roles and functions of this Unit will be to:

- 10.5.1.1. Provide training in use of less lethal devices, including restraints and impact weapons;
- 10.5.1.2. Develop scenario simulation videos for training purposes;
- 10.5.1.3. Provide advanced tactical training for Divisional Operational Support Units; and
- 10.5.1.4. Management and operation of the Fighting in Built Up Areas (FIBUA) Tactical Training Village.

10.6. Firearms Unit

10.6.1. The Firearms Unit will be headed by a Manager at the rank of Inspector within the JCF. The Unit will manage the firearms training, practice and qualification programmes. The roles and functions of this Unit will be to provide:

- 10.6.1.1. Basic firearms training;
- 10.6.1.2. Annual firearms re-qualification for JCF officers;
- 10.6.1.3. Training with the aid of the (Firearm Training System) FATS machine;
- 10.6.1.4. Special weapons training for the JCF Special Weapons and Tactical Team; and
- 10.6.1.5. Advanced firearms course for plainclothes personnel on close protection details.

10.7. Less-Lethal Unit

10.7.1. The Less-Lethal Unit will be led by a Manager at the rank of Inspector within the JCF. This Unit will oversee defensive tactics training, including baton, handcuff, and pepper spray training. The roles and functions of this Unit will include:

- 10.7.1.1. Basic defensive tactics training for JCF members;
- 10.7.1.2. Specialized training in the deployment of pepper spray (OC);
- 10.7.1.3. Instruction on proper handcuffing and use of baton techniques;
- 10.7.1.4. Annual re-qualification in the use of less-lethal weapons;
- 10.7.1.5. Advanced training for specialized units in high-stress scenarios.

10.8. Medical Response Unit

10.8.1. The Medical Response Unit will be led by a Manager at the rank of Inspector within the JCF. This Unit will provide essential medical assistance during all training conducted by the Department of Weapons and Tactical Training. The roles and functions of this Unit will include:

- 10.8.1.1. On-site medical support for all training exercises;
- 10.8.1.2. Emergency medical response training for personnel;
- 10.8.1.3. Coordination with local medical facilities for advanced care;

10.8.1.4. Regular health assessments and wellness checks for training participants.

10.9. The Training Development Unit

- 10.9.1. The Training Development Unit will be led by a Manager at the rank of Inspector within the JCF. This Unit is responsible for the development and review of curricula and policies, ensuring that training programs meet the highest standards of effectiveness and relevance. The roles and functions of this Unit will include:
- 10.9.1.1. Creating comprehensive training curricula that align with current best practices in firearms and tactical training.
 - 10.9.1.2. Regularly evaluating and updating training policies to reflect changes in laws, technology, and operational needs.
 - 10.9.1.3. Collaborating closely with the Curriculum Development Coordination Department to ensure consistency and quality across all training programs.
 - 10.9.1.4. Designing and reviewing assessments to measure trainee competency effectively, ensuring that all personnel are adequately prepared for their roles.
 - 10.9.1.5. Implementing feedback mechanisms to refine training content and delivery based on participant performance and evolving operational requirements.

10.10. Armoury and Range Management Unit

- 10.10.1. The Armoury and Range Management Unit will be headed by a Range Master at the rank of Inspector within the JCF. The Range master is responsible for planning, implementing and conducting firearms training for all sworn personnel. The Range Master is also responsible for ensuring that all personnel comply with the established policies, procedures and orders of the department. The roles and functions of this Unit will be to:
- 10.10.1.1. Establish and enforce policy and standard operating procedures for accessing the NPCJ range;
 - 10.10.1.2. Oversee the maintenance of NPCJ range;
 - 10.10.1.3. Ensure range preparation prior to range exercises;
 - 10.10.1.4. Brief all range instructor details;
 - 10.10.1.5. Supervise range exercises;
 - 10.10.1.6. Brief all range participants for range activities;
 - 10.10.1.7. Ensure NPCJ Shooting Range Policy, Standard Operating Procedures and protocols are adhered to;
 - 10.10.1.8. Verify completion of all range activity documentation and waivers prior to and after range exercises;
 - 10.10.1.9. Keep an inventory of all weapons, ammunition and equipment used during range activities;
 - 10.10.1.10. Oversee assessment of all firearm-qualifying shoots;
 - 10.10.1.11. Ensure qualification scores are properly logged;
 - 10.10.1.12. Secure custody and control of all weapons, ammunition, and related equipment housed at the NPCJ armoury;

- 10.10.1.13. Manage the issuing, receipt, transfer, and return of weapons for training activities;
- 10.10.1.14. Conduct periodic physical inventories of weapons, ammunition and related equipment;
- 10.10.1.15. Maintain and service NPCJ weapons in storage; and
- 10.10.1.16. Oversee testing and evaluation of new training weapons.

10.11. Administration and Records Unit

- 10.11.1. The Administration Unit will be headed by a Manager at the rank of Sergeant within the JCF. The Administration Unit will coordinate the day-to-day activities of the Department. The roles and functions of this Unit will be to:
 - 10.11.1.1. Prepare training returns to Central Administration;
 - 10.11.1.2. Prepare staff returns to Central Administration;
 - 10.11.1.3. Prepare staff duty details;
 - 10.11.1.4. Prepare staff training schedule; and
 - 10.11.1.5. Manage incoming and outgoing departmental correspondences.

10.12. Scheduling of Courses and Assignments

- 10.12.1. Training for College Faculty Programmes
 - 10.12.1.1. The Department will support NPCJ training programmes across all levels and College faculties:
 - 10.12.1.1.1. *Faculty of Initial Probationary Training*
 - 10.12.1.1.1.1. Basic firearms training
 - 10.12.1.1.1.2. Less lethal weapon training
 - 10.12.1.1.1.3. Student Tactical Training
 - 10.12.1.1.2. *Faculty of Leadership and Professional Development*
 - 10.12.1.1.2.1. Department of Supervisory Management
 - 10.12.1.1.2.2. Firearm retraining, requalification, and recertification
 - 10.12.1.1.2.3. Remedial firearm training
 - 10.12.1.1.2.4. Close protection tactics
 - 10.12.1.1.2.5. Staff management tactical module
 - 10.12.1.1.2.6. Tactical Training
 - 10.12.1.1.2.7. Instructor Development Training
 - 10.12.1.1.3. *Faculty of Operations Management and Skills Training*
 - 10.12.1.1.3.1. Motor Vehicle Tactical Training
 - 10.12.1.1.3.2. Systematic Search Course
 - 10.12.1.1.3.3. Quick Response Tactical Training
 - 10.12.1.1.3.4. Operations Field Commanders Course

10.13. Training Programmes for External Formations

- 10.13.1. The College's In-service program shall include an annual schedule of:
 - 10.13.1.1. Firearm user recertification of sworn members;
 - 10.13.1.2. Advance Tactical Training for Divisional Operational Support Units; and

10.13.1.3. Less lethal weapons training.

10.13.2. Requests from other formations within the JCF for training outside of scheduled programmes will be routed through the Director, NPCJ.

10.14. Requests from External Entities

10.14.1. All external requests for training, and or certification must be routed through the Director, NPCJ.

11.0. Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles

11.1. This Policy shall be read in conjunction with the following legislation and guiding principles

11.1.1. The Charter of Fundamental Rights and Freedoms (Constitutional Amendment) Act, 2011

11.1.2. The Firearms Act (Amended)

11.1.3. The Jamaica Constabulary Force Act

11.1.4. Use of Force and Firearms Policy (JCF)

11.1.5. JCF Training Policy

12.0. RELEVANT RECORDS AND FORMS

12.1. NPCJ Organization Chart

12.2. DWTT Organizational Chart

13.0. REVIEW AND REVISION

13.1. The Department of Weapons and Tactical Training (DWTT) Policy and Standard Operating Procedures will be reviewed biennially or as necessary to incorporate JCF and GOJ policy and legislation changes. NPCJ will collaborate with legal and security experts to ensure compliance with evolving standards.